

IBEW Aptitude Test Reading Comprehension

READING COMPREHENSION Exam 12

Part A — Passages and Questions

Time Limit: 51 Minutes

Passage 1

A regional equipment rental company recently changed how it tracks returned tools. Previously, employees checked tools back in by writing the tool name and return date on a paper sheet. If a tool was damaged or missing accessories, that information was sometimes written in the margin or reported verbally to a supervisor.

The company introduced a digital return checklist for each tool category. When a tool is returned, employees select the tool type, confirm that required accessories are present, and record any visible damage. The system then updates the tool's availability status.

Managers report that the new process has reduced confusion about which tools are ready to rent again. It also helps the maintenance team identify damaged items before they are assigned to another customer.

RC12-001

Question: What is the main idea of the passage?

- A) The company stopped renting tools to customers.
 - B) A digital return checklist improved tracking of returned tools.
 - C) Employees now repair all damaged tools immediately.
 - D) Paper return sheets were used only for accessories.
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RC12-002

Question: What problem sometimes occurred under the old process?

- A) Damaged tools were always discarded.
- B) Customers filled out all return records.
- C) Damage or missing accessories were sometimes reported informally.

D) Tools were never returned after rental.

RC12-003

Question: What do employees confirm when using the digital checklist?

- A) That customers paid by cash
 - B) That required accessories are present
 - C) That the rental building is open
 - D) That supervisors approved vacation time
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RC12-004

Question: What does the system update after a tool is returned?

- A) The customer's home address
 - B) The employee's work schedule
 - C) The tool's availability status
 - D) The company's advertising plan
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RC12-005

Question: The word "availability" most nearly means:

- A) Repair cost
 - B) Condition of being ready for use
 - C) Difficulty level
 - D) Length of ownership
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Passage 2

MEMO

To: All Service Department Employees
Subject: Updated Customer Callback Procedure

Beginning June 10, service employees must record customer callback requests in the shared service log. Each entry should include the customer's name, phone number, reason for the call, and the employee assigned to respond.

The change was made because callback requests were previously recorded in several different places, including notebooks, email messages, and individual phone notes. This made it difficult for supervisors to confirm whether every customer had received a response.

Employees should check the shared log at the start and end of each shift.

RC12-006

Question: What is the purpose of the memo?

- A) To announce a new customer callback procedure
 - B) To cancel customer phone service
 - C) To introduce a new employee uniform
 - D) To explain billing rates
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RC12-007

Question: What information should each callback entry include?

- A) Customer name, phone number, reason for the call, and assigned employee
 - B) Employee break times and parking locations
 - C) Product prices and sales tax rates
 - D) Building repair costs and inspection dates
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RC12-008

Question: Why was the procedure changed?

- A) Customers no longer wanted responses.
- B) Callback requests were recorded in too many different places.
- C) Supervisors wanted fewer records.

D) Phone service was permanently removed.

RC12-009

Question: When should employees check the shared log?

- A) Once per year
 - B) Only after a customer complains
 - C) At the start and end of each shift
 - D) Before entering the parking lot
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Passage 3

Many warehouses use cycle counting to monitor inventory accuracy. Instead of counting every item in the warehouse at one time, employees count selected groups of items on a regular schedule. Over time, this allows the company to check inventory records without stopping normal operations for a full physical count.

Cycle counting can help identify problems such as misplaced items, incorrect quantities, or recording errors. If a certain product category repeatedly shows differences between the system record and the actual shelf count, managers may review receiving, picking, or stocking procedures.

The method works best when counts are performed carefully and results are investigated. Simply recording differences without looking for causes may not improve inventory accuracy.

RC12-010

Question: What is the main idea of the passage?

- A) Warehouses should never count inventory.
 - B) Cycle counting helps warehouses monitor inventory accuracy without stopping operations.
 - C) Full physical counts are required every day.
 - D) Inventory records are always correct.
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RC12-011

Question: How is cycle counting different from counting every item at once?

- A) It counts selected groups of items on a regular schedule.
 - B) It avoids checking inventory records.
 - C) It requires customers to count warehouse items.
 - D) It counts only damaged products.
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RC12-012

Question: Which problem can cycle counting help identify?

- A) Employee lunch preferences
 - B) Misplaced items
 - C) Parking shortages
 - D) Customer advertising requests
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RC12-013

Question: What might managers review if repeated inventory differences appear?

- A) Receiving, picking, or stocking procedures
 - B) Employee vacation photos
 - C) Weather reports
 - D) Customer seating charts
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RC12-014

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

- A) Inventory counts are useful only when errors are ignored.
 - B) Cycle counting is most useful when differences are investigated.
 - C) Warehouses should stop normal operations every time an item is counted.
 - D) Recording errors cannot affect inventory accuracy.
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Passage 4

Before modern traffic signals became common, busy intersections were often controlled by police officers or simple signs. As automobile traffic increased, this approach became harder to manage. Drivers sometimes had difficulty knowing when to proceed, especially when traffic came from several directions.

Traffic signals helped create a more orderly system for controlling intersections. By assigning right-of-way through red, yellow, and green lights, signals reduced confusion and helped traffic move more predictably. Later improvements included pedestrian signals, turn arrows, and timing systems that could be adjusted for traffic conditions.

Today, traffic signals remain an important part of road safety. Engineers continue to review signal timing and intersection design to improve safety and reduce delays.

RC12-015

Question: What is the main idea of the passage?

- A) Traffic signals helped make intersections safer and more orderly.
 - B) Police officers no longer work near roads.
 - C) Automobiles are no longer used in cities.
 - D) Pedestrian signals caused traffic systems to fail.
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RC12-016

Question: What made older intersection control methods harder to manage?

- A) A decrease in road use
 - B) Increased automobile traffic
 - C) A lack of road signs anywhere
 - D) The removal of all intersections
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RC12-017

Question: How do traffic signals assign right-of-way?

- A) Through customer requests
- B) Through red, yellow, and green lights

- C) Through handwritten letters
 - D) Through vehicle repair records
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RC12-018

Question: How is the passage organized?

- A) It compares two unrelated machines.
 - B) It explains an earlier problem, a solution, and later improvements.
 - C) It lists instructions for driving a truck.
 - D) It argues against road safety planning.
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Passage 5

A regional packaging company recently began using moisture-resistant labels on shipments that may be exposed to damp conditions. Previously, standard paper labels were used on all shipments. During rainy weather or humid storage conditions, some labels became difficult to read, which occasionally delayed sorting and delivery.

The new labels are designed to remain readable even when exposed to moisture. Shipping employees tested the labels on several product lines before the company expanded their use. Managers found that the labels were especially helpful for outdoor deliveries and warehouse areas where temperature changes caused condensation.

Although the new labels cost more than standard paper labels, company leaders believe the added expense is justified if it reduces delivery problems and customer complaints.

RC12-019

Question: What is the main idea of the passage?

- A) The company stopped using labels on shipments.
 - B) Moisture-resistant labels helped reduce problems caused by unreadable shipping labels.
 - C) Customers now sort all packages themselves.
 - D) Standard paper labels work best in every condition.
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RC12-020

Question: What problem occurred with standard paper labels?

- A) They sometimes became difficult to read in damp conditions.
 - B) They were too large for boxes.
 - C) They included too much customer information.
 - D) They were never used during rainy weather.
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RC12-021

Question: Where were the new labels especially helpful?

- A) In employee breakrooms
 - B) In outdoor deliveries and areas with condensation
 - C) In payroll offices
 - D) In customer parking spaces
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RC12-022

Question: Why do company leaders believe the added expense is justified?

- A) The labels may reduce delivery problems and customer complaints.
 - B) The labels eliminate the need for shipping employees.
 - C) The labels prevent all weather changes.
 - D) The labels make sorting unnecessary.
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RC12-023

Question: The word “justified” most nearly means:

- A) Difficult to read
- B) Shown to be reasonable
- C) Completely hidden
- D) Delayed without cause

Passage 6

Many organizations use document version control to avoid confusion when several people work on the same file. Version control helps users identify the most current document and track changes made over time.

Without version control, employees may accidentally use outdated instructions, duplicate someone else's work, or send customers incorrect information. A clear system may include file names with dates, revision numbers, approval notes, or a shared location where current documents are stored.

Version control works best when everyone follows the same rules. If some employees save separate copies in personal folders while others use the shared system, confusion can continue.

RC12-024

Question: What is the main idea of the passage?

- A) Document version control helps prevent confusion when files are updated or shared.
- B) Employees should keep all documents in personal folders.
- C) Customers should write company documents.
- D) Revision numbers make files impossible to use.

RC12-025

Question: What can happen without version control?

- A) Employees may use outdated instructions.
- B) All files automatically update.
- C) Customers receive fewer documents.
- D) Approval notes disappear from every file.

RC12-026

Question: Which item may be part of a clear version-control system?

- A) Revision numbers
- B) Employee lunch menus

C) Delivery vehicle mileage

D) Weather alerts

RC12-027

Question: Why must everyone follow the same version-control rules?

A) Otherwise, confusion can continue.

B) Otherwise, documents become shorter.

C) Otherwise, customers write all revisions.

D) Otherwise, computers cannot print files.

RC12-028

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A) Shared document systems are useful only if employees use them consistently.

B) Version control prevents every workplace error.

C) Separate personal copies always reduce confusion.

D) Outdated instructions are usually safer than current ones.

Passage 7

Many communities use public noise ordinances to manage sound levels in residential and commercial areas. These rules may limit loud construction work, amplified music, vehicle noise, or other activities during certain hours.

The purpose of a noise ordinance is to balance different needs. Businesses and residents may need to complete work, hold events, or receive deliveries, but nearby people also need reasonable quiet, especially during nighttime hours. Clear rules help reduce disputes by setting expectations for when loud activities are allowed.

Enforcement often depends on complaints, sound measurements, and local procedures. Communities may review ordinances when growth, new businesses, or repeated complaints show that existing rules need adjustment.

RC12-029

Question: What is the passage mainly about?

- A) How communities use noise ordinances to balance activity and quiet
 - B) Why all construction work should be banned
 - C) How vehicles are manufactured
 - D) Why businesses should ignore local rules
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RC12-030

Question: What may a noise ordinance limit?

- A) Loud construction work or amplified music
 - B) Public water treatment
 - C) Employee training records
 - D) Grocery store prices
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RC12-031

Question: Why do clear noise rules help reduce disputes?

- A) They set expectations for when loud activities are allowed.
 - B) They prevent all businesses from operating.
 - C) They remove the need for local procedures.
 - D) They make nighttime hours louder.
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RC12-032

Question: When may communities review noise ordinances?

- A) When growth, new businesses, or repeated complaints suggest changes are needed
- B) Only when no one reports noise
- C) After all commercial areas are closed
- D) Before any sound is produced anywhere

Passage 8

A technical training center recently studied why some students did not complete its evening certification course. The course was designed for adults who were preparing for entry-level technical jobs while continuing to work during the day.

Staff reviewed attendance records and surveyed students who withdrew. The most common reasons were schedule conflicts, transportation issues, and difficulty keeping up with weekly assignments. Several students said they understood the material during class but fell behind when they missed one or two sessions.

In response, the center added a weekly review period and created a system for students to request missed handouts and practice problems. Staff hope these changes will help students recover more quickly after absences.

RC12-033

Question: What was the purpose of the study?

- A) To find out why some students did not complete the evening certification course
- B) To replace all evening courses with daytime classes
- C) To remove technical training from the center
- D) To measure employee parking use

RC12-034

Question: Which reason for withdrawal was commonly reported?

- A) Schedule conflicts
- B) Too many instructors
- C) Lack of classroom lighting
- D) Excessive course advertising

RC12-035

Question: What problem did some students describe after missing sessions?

- A) They fell behind even if they understood the material during class.

- B) They finished the course faster.
 - C) They no longer needed assignments.
 - D) They became instructors immediately.
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RC12-036

Question: Which statement is best supported by the passage?

- A) Support after absences may help adult students stay on track.
 - B) Students who miss class never need review materials.
 - C) Evening courses are designed only for people who do not work.
 - D) Transportation issues cannot affect course completion.
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Part B — Answer Key + Explanations

RC12-001 — Correct: B — Explanation:

The passage focuses on how a digital return checklist improved how returned tools are checked, tracked, and made available for rental again.

RC12-002 — Correct: C — Explanation:

Under the old process, damage or missing accessories were sometimes written in the margin or reported verbally, which made the information less consistent.

RC12-003 — Correct: B — Explanation:

Employees confirm that required accessories are present when using the digital checklist.

RC12-004 — Correct: C — Explanation:

After a return is recorded, the system updates the tool's availability status.

RC12-005 — Correct: B — Explanation:

In context, "availability" means whether the tool is ready and able to be rented again.

RC12-006 — Correct: A — Explanation:

The memo announces the updated customer callback procedure and explains how employees should record requests.

RC12-007 — Correct: A — Explanation:

Each entry should include the customer's name, phone number, reason for the call, and assigned employee.

RC12-008 — Correct: B — Explanation:

The procedure changed because callback requests were being recorded in several different places, making tracking difficult.

RC12-009 — Correct: C — Explanation:

Employees are told to check the shared log at the start and end of each shift.

RC12-010 — Correct: B — Explanation:

The passage explains how cycle counting lets warehouses check inventory accuracy regularly without stopping normal operations.

RC12-011 — Correct: A — Explanation:

Cycle counting involves counting selected groups of items on a regular schedule instead of counting everything at once.

RC12-012 — Correct: B — Explanation:

The passage specifically states that cycle counting can help identify misplaced items, incorrect quantities, and recording errors.

RC12-013 — Correct: A — Explanation:

If differences repeat, managers may review receiving, picking, or stocking procedures to find the cause.

RC12-014 — Correct: B — Explanation:

The passage says cycle counting works best when differences are investigated, not merely recorded.

RC12-015 — Correct: A — Explanation:

The passage explains how traffic signals made intersections more orderly and continue to support road safety.

RC12-016 — Correct: B — Explanation:

Older methods became harder to manage as automobile traffic increased.

RC12-017 — Correct: B — Explanation:

Traffic signals assign right-of-way through red, yellow, and green lights.

RC12-018 — Correct: B — Explanation:

The passage presents an earlier problem, explains traffic signals as the solution, and then describes later improvements.

RC12-019 — Correct: B — Explanation:

The passage focuses on how moisture-resistant labels reduce problems caused by labels becoming unreadable in damp conditions.

RC12-020 — Correct: A — Explanation:

Standard paper labels sometimes became hard to read during rainy weather or humid storage conditions.

RC12-021 — Correct: B — Explanation:

The labels were especially helpful for outdoor deliveries and warehouse areas where condensation occurred.

RC12-022 — Correct: A — Explanation:

Leaders believe the higher cost is justified because the labels may reduce delivery problems and customer complaints.

RC12-023 — Correct: B — Explanation:

In context, “justified” means shown to be reasonable or worth the added expense.

RC12-024 — Correct: A — Explanation:

The passage explains that version control helps employees identify current documents and avoid confusion when files change.

RC12-025 — Correct: A — Explanation:

Without version control, employees may use outdated instructions, duplicate work, or send incorrect information.

RC12-026 — Correct: A — Explanation:

Revision numbers are listed as one possible part of a clear version-control system.

RC12-027 — Correct: A — Explanation:

The passage states that if some employees do not follow the shared system, confusion can continue.

RC12-028 — Correct: A — Explanation:

The passage supports the conclusion that shared systems work only when employees use them consistently.

RC12-029 — Correct: A — Explanation:

The passage explains how noise ordinances balance the needs of businesses, residents, and public quiet.

RC12-030 — Correct: A — Explanation:

Noise ordinances may limit loud construction work, amplified music, vehicle noise, and similar activities.

RC12-031 — Correct: A — Explanation:

Clear rules reduce disputes by setting expectations for when loud activities are allowed.

RC12-032 — Correct: A — Explanation:

Communities may review ordinances when growth, new businesses, or repeated complaints show that changes may be needed.

RC12-033 — Correct: A — Explanation:

The study was conducted to learn why some students did not complete the evening certification course.

RC12-034 — Correct: A — Explanation:

Schedule conflicts were one of the most common reasons students withdrew.

RC12-035 — Correct: A — Explanation:

Several students said they understood the material during class but fell behind after missing sessions.

RC12-036 — Correct: A — Explanation:

The added review period and missed-material system support the idea that help after absences may keep adult students on track.

Answer Summary

Question Answer

RC12-001 B

RC12-002 C

Question Answer

RC12-003 B
RC12-004 C
RC12-005 B
RC12-006 A
RC12-007 A
RC12-008 B
RC12-009 C
RC12-010 B
RC12-011 A
RC12-012 B
RC12-013 A
RC12-014 B
RC12-015 A
RC12-016 B
RC12-017 B
RC12-018 B
RC12-019 B
RC12-020 A
RC12-021 B
RC12-022 A
RC12-023 B
RC12-024 A
RC12-025 A
RC12-026 A
RC12-027 A
RC12-028 A
RC12-029 A
RC12-030 A
RC12-031 A
RC12-032 A
RC12-033 A
RC12-034 A
RC12-035 A
RC12-036 A